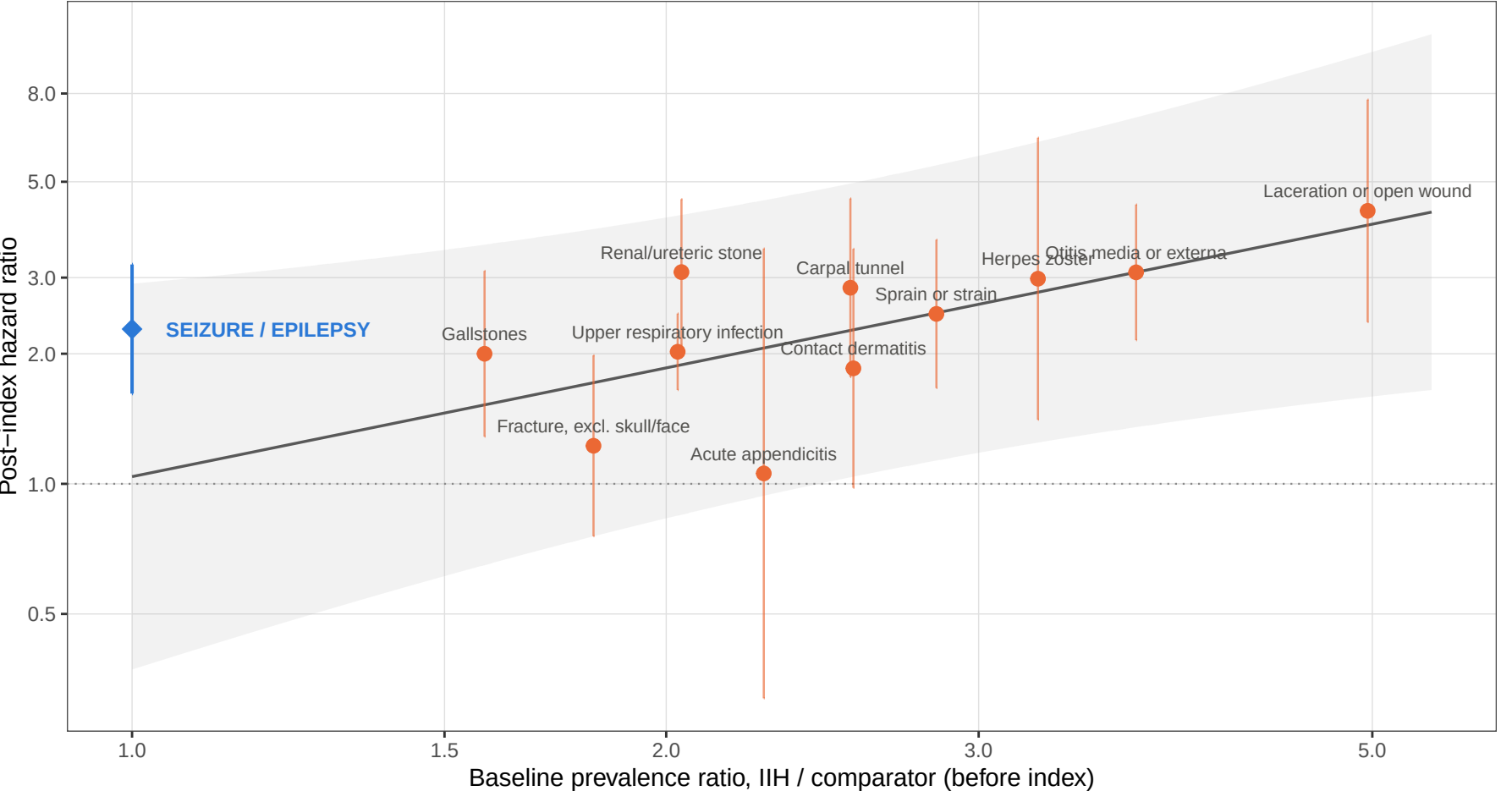


Apparent effect scales with baseline imbalance across negative controls

Eleven outcomes with no plausible causal link to IIH. Both axes log scale; band is the 95% prediction interval.



The relationship is real ($r = 0.66$, $p = 0.026$; slope 0.84, SE 0.31), which is what detection bias looks like: the more a condition was already over-recorded in the IIH arm, the larger its apparent post-index excess. Extrapolating to perfect baseline balance predicts a detection-only hazard ratio of 1.04 (0.37 to 2.90). Seizure is plotted at a ratio of 1 because prior seizure was an exclusion in both arms. Its estimate of 2.28 lies above the predicted 1.04 but INSIDE that prediction interval, so calibration alone cannot establish that the association exceeds detection bias. The adjustment test in the companion figure is the stronger evidence.